

What Yonkers Residents Complain About

The leading grievances in public comments on the City of Yonkers' official
Facebook and Instagram accounts
May 2021 – August 2026 (all collected data)

Period analysed	May 2021 – August 2026 (all collected data)
Months carrying comments	May 2021 – Aug 2026
Comments collected	9,697
Of which substantive	6,111 (excludes emoji-only and tag-only replies)
Complaints identified	895 (14.6% of substantive)
Sources	facebook.com/cityofyonkers · instagram.com/cityofyonkers
Prepared	August 08, 2026

How this was built

Public comments were collected from the City of Yonkers' official Facebook page and Instagram account covering May 2021 – August 2026 (all collected data). Every comment was screened for grievance language — complaint markers such as demands to fix something, reports of neglect, questions about why a problem persists, or explicit expressions of frustration. Comments that were purely congratulatory, informational, or off-topic were excluded from the counts.

9,697 comments were collected. A large share of any city page's replies are emoji, tags and one-word reactions, which express no grievance either way, so the **6,111** comments carrying actual prose form the base for every rate in this report. Of those, **895 (14.6%)** registered as complaints and were sorted into civic categories using a weighted keyword classifier. A single comment can touch more than one issue; it is counted once under its dominant theme, with secondary themes tracked separately under “mentions.”

What the numbers do and don't represent

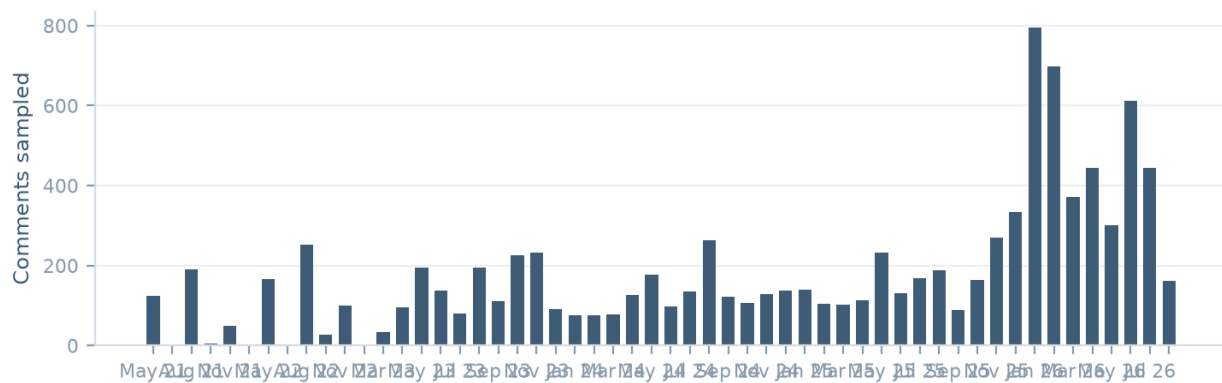
These are the complaints residents chose to post publicly on the city's own channels. They are a strong signal of what frustrates the engaged public, but they are not a representative survey of all Yonkers residents. Comment volume is also shaped by what the city posts about and by moderation. Read the ranking as *what dominates the public conversation*, not as a measured incidence of each problem across the city.

Collection notes

- This document pools every comment collected across the whole 2021-2026 effort into a single analysis: 9,697 unique comments (4,541 Facebook, 5,156 Instagram) spanning 54 months from May 2021 to August 2026.
- It is not the sum of the six March-November reports. Those windows exclude December, January and February; this pool includes them. 392 of the 895 complaints here - 44 percent - fall outside the six windows. That single difference is why snow and storm response leads this ranking but barely registers in the seasonal reports.
- Coverage is uneven across the span. Instagram's public feed could not be paged back past March 2023, so 2021 and 2022 are Facebook-only. Facebook history was gathered as date-bounded slices rather than an exhaustive crawl, so each year is a sample of that year rather than every post published in it.
- Volume rises steeply toward the present: 28 complaints are dated 2021 against 541 dated 2026. Recent years therefore dominate this pooled ranking. For a like-for-like read across years, use the six period reports, where each period is normalised to its own share.
- Facebook comments were pulled from the most-commented posts in each window. Heavily discussed posts are over-represented on purpose - that is where grievances collect - so these shares describe the complaint conversation, not the average post.
- Instagram contributes the comments returned alongside each post, a broader but shallower slice than Facebook.
- Emoji-only, tag-only and one-word reactions are counted in the total collected but excluded from the base used for the complaint rate, since they express no grievance either way.

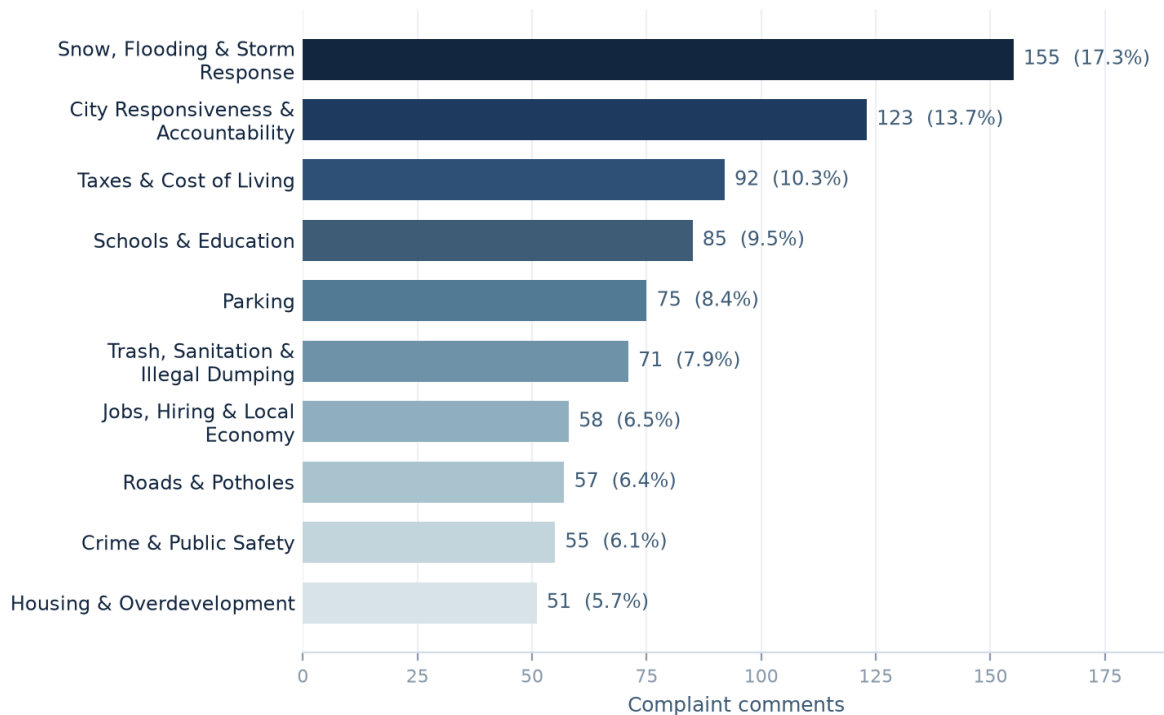
- Comments posted by official city accounts are excluded, as the scrapers surface them alongside residents' replies.
- A category can rank low simply because the city rarely posted about it. Treat the ranking as a measure of the conversation the city's own posts invited, not a census of civic opinion.

Comments sampled by month



The top 10 complaints

Snow, Flooding & Storm Response is the single largest source of complaints, accounting for 17.3% of every grievance posted. The three leading themes — Snow, Flooding & Storm Response, City Responsiveness & Accountability, Taxes & Cost of Living — together make up 41% of all complaints, meaning most of what residents raise on the city's channels concentrates in a handful of recurring issues.

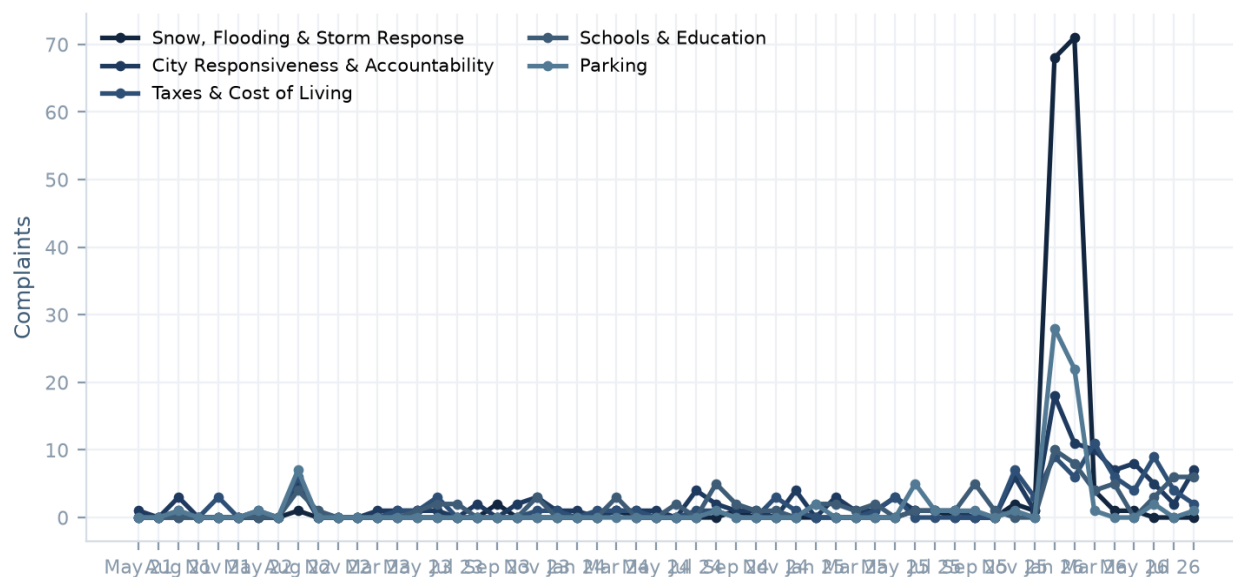


#	Complaint category	Comments	Share	Avg. likes
1	Snow, Flooding & Storm Response	155	17.3%	4.1
2	City Responsiveness & Accountability	123	13.7%	2.3
3	Taxes & Cost of Living	92	10.3%	4.7
4	Schools & Education	85	9.5%	2.5
5	Parking	75	8.4%	3.2
6	Trash, Sanitation & Illegal Dumping	71	7.9%	1.6
7	Jobs, Hiring & Local Economy	58	6.5%	2.3
8	Roads & Potholes	57	6.4%	3.2
9	Crime & Public Safety	55	6.1%	6.8
10	Housing & Overdevelopment	51	5.7%	2.8

How the top issues moved over time

Monthly complaint counts for the five largest categories. Peaks follow a specific triggering event — a snowstorm, a violent incident, a budget vote — that pulls a burst of comment traffic onto the city's posts.

Read month-to-month movement with care. These lines track how much was sampled as much as how much was said — a month with few sampled comments cannot produce many complaints. Check the sampling volume on the methodology page before reading any swing as a real change in resident sentiment.



The complaints in residents' own words

Each category below shows its rank, volume, and a selection of verbatim comments. Quotes are reproduced as posted, including spelling and punctuation. Commenter names are omitted.

1

Snow, Flooding & Storm Response

155 complaints · 17.3% of all complaints · Facebook 119 · Instagram 36



"Yonkers is horrible, when it comes to parking and snow plowing. The fact that it has many many hills. Side streets are very dangerous. At least spread some salt on the steep hills, that are frozen solid. It's a gamble driving on side roads even two days after the storm."

Facebook · 2026 · on: "DPW crews have been focused primarily on the City's main roads throughout the day as the s..."

"DPW PLOWED 2 FEET OF COMPACT SNOW AND ICE ON TO MY CLEARED SIDE WALK YESTERDAY ! TELL YOUR DRIVERS TO SLOW DOWN ! !"

Facebook · 2026 · 1 likes · on: "Parks crews are tackling 34 sets of stairs, four miles of sidewalks, parking lots and comm..."

"Yonkers suck at plowing it will look worse then the last snow storm there will be no place to park on the side streets and can barely drive on them"

Instagram · 2026 · 1 likes · on: "■ ENFORCEMENT IN PROGRESS ■ The City is now ticketing and towing vehicles still parked on..."

"Real question is, Can you attach a plow on these bad boys, Other wise the ONLY FOOTPRINT i want to see on the Yonkers streets post snow storm is yours Spano, helping shovel snow."

Instagram · 2026 · on: "Meet "The Battle." Our newest all-electric garbage truck is now part of Yonkers' growing..."

2

City Responsiveness & Accountability

123 complaints · 13.7% of all complaints · Facebook 62 · Instagram 61



"The most corrupt city in New York State. How many members of the Spano Crime Family are profiting from the mayors control. Oh and I heard the mayor is already bribing the city council to give him another term since he can't find another job."

Instagram · 2026 · 1 likes · on: "This week in Yonkers: Potholes getting filled Cherry blossoms starting to bloom Dispatche..."

"I had the chance of meeting him and we discussed Yonkers as a whole, this was in 2012. He and I talk about changing Yonkers and honestly I thought this guy is all talk and he's just talking bull like most people in office. I feel like he has out did my perception of him, Mayor Spano your doing a fantastic job keep up the good work."

Facebook · 2026 · 1 likes · on: "Yonkers is continuing the transformation of the former Mulford Gardens site. The new Park..."

"@— that is correct. The whole council is corrupt too. Sneaky moves are happening behind closed doors - Spano and his council are horrible corrupt individuals."

Instagram · 2026 · on: "Did not expect the clock at Yonkers City Hall to look like this ■ Thanks to @mayormikesp..."

"Meanwhile the seniors are still in an unsafe building. Many have stopped going disgusted with all the empty promises and their ignored pleas. The promises made to them for a gazebo by July and a BBQ not fulfilled. We are entering fall. Where is the community in this picture? When will it be about the community? Sadly, it can not be until we have representatives that truly care about the people."

Facebook · 2021 · 12 likes · on: ">■ Grand Opening & Ribbon Cutting| Coyne Park Fitness Station 771 McLean Avenue Yonkers, N..."

3

Taxes & Cost of Living

92 complaints · 10.3% of all complaints · Facebook 60 · Instagram 32



"We need lower property TAX, and better ROADS."

Facebook · 2026 · 14 likes · on: "BIG NEWS FOR DOWNTOWN YONKERS! ■ The City of Yonkers has been awarded \$10 million through..."

"When will the income tax surcharge be eliminated You are bankrupting the citizens of Yonkers"

Facebook · 2025 · 4 likes · on: "Big win for Yonkers! ■■■ We're receiving \$10 million from Governor Hochul's Mid-Hudson M..."

"Financial accountability. What does the city do with the funds they grab from tax payers? Cost of living is ridiculous in this city run by a someone who seems to have most of his family on the payroll"

Instagram · 2026 · 1 likes · on: "Yonkers, as we await the passage of New York State's Budget, this year's Executive Budget ..."

"All that Hollywood money pouring in and you still charge a residency tax on every paycheck and a leaving tax when you move out of Yonkers... crooked politicians in a crooked city!"

Facebook · 2025 · 3 likes · on: "Mayor Mike Spano toured the new Mediapro Studios on North Broadway with Robert Halmi the f..."

4

Schools & Education

85 complaints · 9.5% of all complaints · Instagram 48 · Facebook 37



"GRADUATION RATE!!! Have you ever dealt with Yonkers Board of Education, the biggest pile of trash I've ever seen in my life! Biggest city in Westchester County with the worst school district ever! They don't care about these kids."

Instagram · 2026 · on: "Mayor Mike Spano (@mayormikespano) gives me the elevator pitch on the City of Yonkers and ..."

"Oh man what would our children's education do without a bunch of pedophiles guiding them while in school. How about paying teachers better and upping security. You people in office are not only a joke but you play dangerous games"

Instagram · 2024 · 4 likes · on: "This week, @mayormikespano swore in the incredible members of the Mayor's LGBTQ+ Advisory ..."

"Meanwhile the education and safety of student's etc in all of the Yonkers school system SUCKS ■■■■■■!!"

Instagram · 2024 · 1 likes · on: "Big news! ■ A cool investment in our children's future: The City of Yonkers and Yonkers P..."

"Wait till tomorrow when school busses are getting stuck . My street was plowed once since Sunday cars have a hard time getting in and out. How is a school bus full of children getting through."

Facebook · 2026 · 7 likes · on: "■ Alternate Side Parking Update ■ ■ Wednesday (1/28) and Thursday (1/29) Alternate side s..."

5

Parking

75 complaints · 8.4% of all complaints · Facebook 57 · Instagram 18



"How can alternate side be enforced when there is no where to park on many streets? Some areas, like mine, do not have access to alternate parking places."

Facebook · 2026 · 5 likes · on: "■ WEEKEND SNOW REMOVAL / NO PARKING NOTICE ■ Friday 1/30 – Sunday 2/1 ■■ Alternate side p..."

"Alternate side of street parking suspended!! But parking meters are in effect ?? How about clearing the metered spots !!"

Facebook · 2026 · 5 likes · on: "Parks crews are tackling 34 sets of stairs, four miles of sidewalks, parking lots and comm..."

"Tickets were given today to my entire street prob 20 cars and you guys did not announce anything in advance Last night i checked the website and it said that alternate parking is still suspended with no additional information All these tickets should be dismissed ppl literally have nowhere to park and you guys should communicate better Respectfully"

Facebook · 2026 · 5 likes · on: "■ WEEKEND SNOW REMOVAL / NO PARKING NOTICE ■ Friday 1/30 – Sunday 2/1 ■■ Alternate side p..."

"Suspending alternate side parking on Warburton means folks CAN park there. That means folks will remain parked on the east side of the street—the snow emergency route—where the snow needs to be removed. Instructions should say : No parking on the east side of Warburton remains in effect."

Facebook · 2026 · 3 likes · on: "DPW Snow Removal Update While crews continue plowing primary and secondary roads, additio..."

6

Trash, Sanitation & Illegal Dumping

71 complaints · 7.9% of all complaints · Facebook 48 · Instagram 23



"Can we have a conversation about how filthy our streets are? Every road littered with trash, every exit ramp to any thruway, parkway or highway look worse than a garbage dump. Please do something."

Instagram · 2026 · 2 likes

"If this is true then why aren't summonses given to the apartment buildings and homes that put the recyclables out with the garbage. I see it everyday and watch the sanitation people take it with the garbage. This city doesn't uphold the recycling laws. I want a good answer not an excuse or it being passed on to the next guy"

Instagram · 2023 · 1 likes · on: "On #NationalRecyclingDay, Yonkers takes a stand for a cleaner, greener tomorrow! ■ Our P..."

"They are dumping garbage everywhere. Last week coming home I saw a stack of mattresses on central Avenue. Last year I saw on Facebook that someone dumped a truckload of used tires at a park in Yonkers. Really disgusting"

Facebook · 2022 · on: "■ Message from Mayor Mike Spano on the illegal dumping that occurs along I-87 Major Deegan..."

"Great now they have to place cameras there. Unfortunately this dumping problem is everywhere. Mr. Spano you have to change those rules at the sawmill River Road sanitation dump site. People from Yonkers are willing to bring garbage there but they don't let them because of those strick rules and regulations. People have no clue where else to dump so that's why they dump everywhere around yonkers."

Facebook · 2022 · on: "Job well done! ■■■..."

7

Jobs, Hiring & Local Economy

58 complaints · 6.5% of all complaints · Facebook 34 · Instagram 24



"Mike Spano you really are a POS! stop loathing the camera thinking your a star and do your job you mutt! Hire competent workers instead of DEI overpaid theft of services employees."

Facebook · 2026 · on: "Yonkers is now hiring Emergency Snow Shovelers to support ongoing winter cleanup across th..."

"Where are the jobs? I've been checking since they opened and have never seen them hiring"

Instagram · 2025 · on: "So excited to share the latest Hollywood on Hudson update with all of you! Yonkers isn't j..."

"An you Mr mayor have did a horrible job of giving these kids outlets but you built by the water pretty nice tho ■■■"

Facebook · 2026 · 16 likes · on: "Mayor Spano calls on lawmakers to address the root causes of gun violence following the fa..."

"Let's help kid our kids off the streets. We need summer programs jobs for teenagers. In What's the money in that"

Facebook · 2026 · 11 likes · on: "Yonkers is leading the pack in creating more homes for New Yorkers. 3,000 new housing uni..."

8

Roads & Potholes

57 complaints · 6.4% of all complaints · Facebook 35 · Instagram 22



"Fixing potholes? Try paving all streets instead of patching them for years. What a joke"

Instagram · 2026 · on: "Yonkers, I've heard your concerns. After a tough winter, our crews have already filled ov..."

"Maybe try fixing the potholes, the roads are dangerous."

Facebook · 2026 · 1 likes · on: "Yonkers is leading the pack in creating more homes for New Yorkers. 3,000 new housing uni..."

"How was the winter harsh? Stop spending taxpayers \$\$\$\$\$ in other places and fix the ALL the roads. Patching a road isn't considered fixing it, you are just putting a band-aid on it to do less work. #uselesspoliticians"

Facebook · 2021 · 6 likes · on: "The City of Yonkers fills over 3,000 potholes in over 70 different areas in two months!..."

"Hope there is an update when some of these roads are getting paved???"

Instagram · 2024 · 5 likes · on: "Introducing Yonkers-Tron – our sleek new LED display sign on the Government Center Garage ..."

9

Crime & Public Safety

55 complaints · 6.1% of all complaints · Instagram 28 · Facebook 27



"Stolen guns are null and void when it comes to law making at the federal level. Maybe the cash bail or halt policies made by the government in albany should be repealed to deter this type of violent crimes. Criminals aren't stupid. Just get a minor to do the violent crime and they're out on the street the next day."

Facebook · 2026 · 26 likes · on: "Mayor Spano calls on lawmakers to address the root causes of gun violence following the fa..."

"first it is not the gun like it is not the car who speeds and kills .. it is how these kids are being raised as well as how the parenting is .. the liberal light on crime policies.. the anti police attitude .. kids have no consequences to anything they do wrong .. the dumbing down of education they keep lowering the bar instead of raising the bar so kids have goals to achieve to better themselves"

Facebook · 2026 · 149 likes · on: "Mayor Spano calls on lawmakers to address the root causes of gun violence following the fa..."

"Ughhhh maybe if you stop letting criminals back out in the street after 5 mins of being arrested, it would make people think before committing crimes. There are. NO CONSEQUENCES so people just dont care. If it wasn't a gun, it'd be a knife, bat, car etc. The problem isn't guns, its the fact people can commit crimes and go on about their day like nothing happened"

Facebook · 2026 · 20 likes · on: "Mayor Spano calls on lawmakers to address the root causes of gun violence following the fa..."

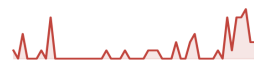
"Stop blaming and let's work together for a solution. You know nothing about these kids. How do you know they come from broken homes? You blame the parents but how do you know thats the problem. There is a gang problem in Yonkers that is ignore. I have no solutions to why young kids are shooting each other on the streets. I just pray that it can be addressed and not forgotten."

Facebook · 2026 · 7 likes · on: "Mayor Spano calls on lawmakers to address the root causes of gun violence following the fa..."

10

Housing & Overdevelopment

51 complaints · 5.7% of all complaints · Facebook 31 · Instagram 20



"Why does he have to ask for school funding with all these building projects going up??? Cause our tax dollars are going into their pockets that's why!! Ridiculous to ask for funds should be getting funds from these billionaires putting up these high rises from the developers not tax payers!!! More buildings more traffic more crime more traffic!! But more money in their pockets ■"

Instagram · 2024 · 4 likes · on: "This week's Your Yonkers Now highlights the diversity of Yonkers plus more on the Mayor's ..."

"Hudson piers requires tenants to make 66 times the income for affordable housing. What a joke"

Facebook · 2026 · 1 likes · on: "Yonkers is leading the pack in creating more homes for New Yorkers. 3,000 new housing uni..."

"Is this the building that has been without heat for a year now- tenants are forced to cook with electric hobs. When Con Ed wanted the gas system replaced or would not pass the existing gas lines, without major modifications. Westchester Power should be able to give great rates, even though the landlord let the utilities fall into disrepair it seems"

Facebook · 2026 · 7 likes · on: "A major investment in Yonkers housing is underway. A \$35 million project at Palisade Tower..."

"Mayor stop lying when you have landlords of building raising rent and throwing out tenant because they refuse to pay a 42 % increase"

Facebook · 2026 · on: "Yonkers is leading the pack in creating more homes for New Yorkers. 3,000 new housing uni..."

Full category ranking

#	Category	Primary	Mentions	Share
1	Snow, Flooding & Storm Response	155	214	17.3%
2	City Responsiveness & Accountability	123	140	13.7%
3	Taxes & Cost of Living	92	114	10.3%
4	Schools & Education	85	120	9.5%
5	Parking	75	97	8.4%
6	Trash, Sanitation & Illegal Dumping	71	91	7.9%
7	Jobs, Hiring & Local Economy	58	84	6.5%
8	Roads & Potholes	57	66	6.4%
9	Crime & Public Safety	55	59	6.1%
10	Housing & Overdevelopment	51	66	5.7%
11	Parks & Public Spaces	26	30	2.9%
12	Homelessness & Quality of Life	22	26	2.5%
13	Street Lighting & Infrastructure	16	19	1.8%
14	Traffic, Speeding & Reckless Driving	9	15	1.0%

"Primary" counts comments whose dominant theme is that category. "Mentions" counts every comment that raises the issue at all, including alongside another complaint, so mentions exceed primary counts for issues that travel together.